

Variation × Selection

LinkedIn post — ready-to-paste plain text below the framing note

Framing (why this version)

This post makes no unfalsifiable claims. No "99% of hallucination removed," no efficiency figures, no "research paper" — none of that was ever measured, so none of it is here. What remains is defensible if anyone asks "show me."

The post (plain text — paste this)

"LLMs are just next-token predictors."

I hear this often — sometimes from brilliant people — and I think it mistakes the method for the meaning.

"Just neurons firing" never explained away human thought. "Just differential reproduction" never made evolution less astonishing. The word doing all the work is "just."

A few things I keep coming back to:

Breakthroughs look obvious — only after they work. They are almost always a recombination of simple ideas hiding in plain sight. We just lacked the eyes to look past the assumed impossibility.

The spark is rarely "reasoning." Ramanujan saw theorems in dreams. Kekule found the benzene ring in a dream of a snake biting its tail. Poincare's insight arrived as he stepped onto a bus. Discovery is pre-rational — intuition, incubation, a trained sixth sense.

And that spark often comes from an unusually open mind. There is real science here: a loosened perceptual filter — psychologists call it reduced latent inhibition — lets more of the world reach awareness, and paired with high intelligence it predicts creative achievement. There is even a modest, replicated link between creativity and the bipolar spectrum. But it follows an inverted-U: a little openness opens doors; too much drowns. The gift and the affliction can be the same door.

Which is the whole point: openness alone is a notebook of unverified wonders. Ramanujan needed Hardy. The dream needs the test.

Intelligence is not spark or rigor. It is the marriage of the two — generate freely, then validate relentlessly, and keep the one in a million that survives.

We should not sanitize the freedom out of our minds — or our machines. We should pair it with the discipline that turns a wild guess into a discovery.

Variation × selection. That is how breakthroughs have always happened.

#AI #Creativity #Innovation #Neuroscience #MachineLearning

Note: LinkedIn does not render Markdown and caps posts at 3,000 characters. The text above is plain and within the limit.